College of the Siskiyous Annual Program Update

Program: Library **Date:** December 15, 2021

Faculty Completing Form: Jude Baldwin

1. **Describe annual progress / changes / events in the program.**

The Library has faced another challenging year since our last Annual Program Review Update (Dec. 2020). These include:

- Functioning with only one employee for all of 2021
- Continuing to adapt services and operations to the coronavirus pandemic

Marcia Eblen and Linda Kiely both retired in 2020 (in June and December respectively) and neither position has been re-filled. The Library was informed that only one position was going to be replaced going forward. Due to this downsizing of staff, Dean Val Roberts and remaining library staff member, Jude Baldwin (faculty librarian), re-wrote the classified job description. Additional responsibilities for serving as the Library Services Platform (LSP) administrator were added to the job and the position was submitted for reclassification. The reclassification was successful and the position was approved for funding, but the process was lengthy, causing the position to not be advertised until August 2021. The position remained open until November 2021 in order to have a small pool of three applicants that met minimum qualifications. If December interviews are successful, a new employee will hopefully start in the Library in January 2022.

Library operations were impacted by having only one staff member during 2021. Many services were suspended, most notably interlibrary loan lending (sending our materials to other libraries) and local history research services. It has impacted instruction and our ability to support students since the faculty librarian has been unable to create planned self-enrolled Canvas modules covering library and research topics and has had minimal time to create new and/or update existing video tutorials, handouts, and Canvas Commons support modules. The Library's collection development approach has been modified to rely more heavily on well-respected book series rather than emphasizing stand-alone title selection. New purchased and donated books are not being added to the catalog in a timely manner and there is a large backlog of materials that need to be reshelved. The Library has not been able to provide student jobs on campus other than maintaining work for 1-2 students who were employed and trained prior to the start of the pandemic. The Library is behind on budget spending and management for this point in FY21-22.

Our ability to be physically open was also impacted and in-person open hours have been greatly reduced. Although the Library had been physically open for Fall 2020, we made the difficult decision to close for Spring 2021 due to the difficulties and uncertainties of operating with just one staff member. We were also physically closed for Summer Session 2021. In anticipation of hiring a staff member in early Fall, the Library opened for half days from 8:00 a.m. – 12:00 p.m. Monday – Thursday, with the hope that more hours could be added once staff was hired. Since the hiring process was slower than expected, hours did not change for the semester. There was no backup plan to keep the Library open if the librarian needed to make in-person class visits, had planned time off, or required an extended absence; the Library did need to close occasionally for the first two reasons.

As of December 6, 2021, the Library had more in-person use than in Fall 2020, with 157 non-employee in-person visitors (compared to 103 visitors in 2020). While most were students (121), 36 were

community members. Most student visits were brief: of the 111 students we have length-of-visit information for, 63 students (56.8%) stayed for 15 minutes or less, 16 (14.4%) stayed between 16-59 minutes, and 32 (28.8%) for 60 minutes or more. Of the 31 students who stayed an hour or more, the most popular reason was to study/use the wifi (26), followed distantly by Books/textbooks (4) and computer use (1). In the first half of the semester, several students were using the Library regularly to attend synchronous Zoom classes and account for much of this longer use (study/wifi). Overall, the primary reasons for visiting the Library were for printing, to study and/or use the wifi, and for books/textbooks.

- Printing: 37
- Study/wifi: 36
- Books/textbooks: 32
- Other: 8
- Computer use: 6
- Not recorded: 1
- Take a break: 1

The students using the Library to attend their synchronous classes in the first half of the semester were coming during the 10:00 – 11:00 hour, causing a significant bump during that hour. Otherwise, student use times were spread fairly evenly throughout the morning. The Library was not officially open after noon.

Time of arrival	Number of students	Percent of students*
8:00 – 9:00	19	15.8%
9:00 – 10:00	22	18.3%
10:00 – 11:00	42	35%
11:00 – 12:00	24	20%
12:00 – 1:00	11	9.2%
1:00 – 2:00	0	0
2:00 – 3:00	2	1.7%
After 3:00	0	0

*Out of 120 (one student visit does not have a time recorded)

In addition to our physically open hours, the Library offered remote services from 8:00 a.m. – 4:00 p.m. Monday – Friday. Students who could not visit the Library in person could get help by text, phone, email, or Zoom (drop-in hours and appointments).

The Library kept all of our initial pandemic adjustments in place, such as texting services and drop-in Zoom times, and made several additional improvements:

- We continue to add to our collection of video tutorials, including videos about using library ebooks as textbooks
- We worked with the web site team to redesign the Research Help and Articles and Databases pages

- We created a Textbook web page to raise awareness of textbook support and options on campus, including Zero Textbook Cost (ZTC) classes and library ebooks
- We continue to purchase textbooks as library ebooks whenever possible, including trying a new ebook vendor (OverDrive)
- Library ebooks are now included on the ZTC course list when concurrent access limits can accommodate class use
- The Library converted all extra copies of reserve materials from 2-day or 3-week checkouts to end-of-semester checkouts.
- To assist with textbook access, the Library arranged for the Academic Success Center (ASC) and Basecamp HQ staff to have keys to the Library. Students who wish to use a reserve textbook when the Library is closed can request to do so in the ASC or HQ. Staff will try to contact the Library to see if the librarian is available but, if not, staff can enter the Library, record the use on a simple tracking form, and allow the student to use the materials in either the ASC or HQ.

The Library continues to provide classroom faculty many opportunities to incorporate library/research support into their classes. The Library had hoped to provide a new support option by creating self-enrolled courses covering basic research skills. The librarian was unable to find the time to finish creating these modules in time for Fall 2021 but has a goal of creating them for Spring 2022.

The Library has made additional progress on some of its goals identified in our AY19-20 Comprehensive Program Review 4-Year Action Plan.

a) *GOAL: The Library will have adequate staffing to meet our workload needs and provide adequate open hours*.
    - The Library was told that it is expected to operate with only one 12-month Library Technician and one faculty librarian (195-day contract) for the near future. The Library Technician position was re-written and re-classified as described above. If December interviews are successful, a new employee will hopefully start in the Library in January 2022.
    - The Library began using Microsoft Forms to track statistics in Fall 2021. So far, this has proved easy and convenient and will make compiling statistics much easier. Extrapolated statistics may not be necessary. This will be re-evaluated at the end of Spring 2022 once it has been in use for a while by multiple staff members.

b) GOAL: The Library will have increased instructional activities for students, including offering a credit-bearing Research Skills and/or Information Literacy course
    - The Library continued to create more video tutorials for students
    - The Library redesigned the Research Help page to be more user-friendly, which will be especially important as the quantity of resources goes up. More video tutorials and handouts have been created or curated to add to this collection of resources. Many have also now been integrated into the Articles & Databases page so that students have convenient access at a potential point of need. The Library also created a Textbook web page to raise awareness of textbook support and options on campus, including Zero Textbook Cost (ZTC) classes and library ebooks.

- The curriculum for a 1-credit class, Library Research Information Literacy (LIBR 1001), was approved in Summer 2021. Due to the current staff shortages, the faculty librarian did not have time to get the class ready for Fall 2021 and the same will likely be true for Spring 2022. It is uncertain how LIBR 1001 fits into overall class scheduling since it is one credit and does not meet any degree or certificate requirements. The college will consider hiring an adjunct to teach LIBR 1001 if it determines a good fit into course scheduling.
- While not specifically listed in our Action Plan, the faculty librarian has again started to lead EdTALKs on research topics, which supports this goal. EdTALKs are informal 30-45 minute workshops conducted via Zoom. The Library offered 14 EdTALKs through Fall with 21 students attending. (See Appendix A for a list of EdTALKs).
- The faculty librarian and Basecamp HQ staff took their EdTALK called "Textbook Connection" for in-person visits with every EDUC 0670 section to talk about textbook resources and options and to offer on-the-spot assistance in getting textbooks.
- The Library's drop-in Zoom hours are cross-listed on the Academic Success Center's Tutor page to increase student awareness of our services.
- The faculty librarian met with Pillar 3 Task Force 4, which focuses on faculty training for integrating student support. They are interested in the Library's project to create a self-enrolled module covering library research topics and offered many suggestions for how this could be set up to meet both faculty and student needs. The Library hopes to start offering these self-enrolled workshops in Spring 2022.

c) *GOAL: The Library will have greater student engagement from developing a student-friendly space, from adapting to the ways students use technology, from increased activities, and through access to resources that meets student needs*

- The Library ran a brief "we're here for you" social media marketing campaign at the end of Spring 2021 to raise awareness of library research support.
- Tech Services no longer purchases Chromebooks for campus use but recommended an inexpensive laptop with similar capabilities. This was purchased in Spring 2021 and Tech Services made sure it was set up for Proctorio testing.
- LRC 9 is now available as a multipurpose room for group study, Zoom meetings, and video viewing. It will still also be used as a local history research space.
- The Library again began hosting movie nights in Fall 2021. These have been made possible by letting go of security concerns (primarily theft of materials) and because of Austin Toney, new Assistant Director of Student Housing and a co-advisor for ASB. Austin quickly became comfortable with the equipment and attended all events. This has allowed groups to offer movie nights on weekends and very late into the evening without library staff being present. The Lodges hosted movie nights for residents on October 30 and December 14; ASB hosted a movie night open to all students (with performance rights) on November 17.

- Many academic libraries are eliminating overdue fines as a way to remove barriers to library use and be more equitable. The COS Library put together materials for a proposal to go "fine free," eliminating overdue/late fines on all circulating materials, including reserves, and the processing fee on unreturned/damaged materials. The proposal will be sent to Instruction Council in Spring 2022; if accepted, a few BPs and APs will need to be updated.
- In researching the elimination of fines, the Library found several studies that indicated longer checkout periods could also eliminate a barrier that prevents some students from using the Library. The Library has implemented semester-long checkout periods for "regular" books since the pandemic started and intends to continue.

d) GOAL: Increase faculty engagement with the library

- The Library applied for CARES/HEERF funds to subscribe to *Academic Video Online* (AVON) for one year to better support faculty needs for video at this time. It will also serve as an extended trial for AVON so that faculty can offer opinions about which collection to keep going forward (we probably cannot afford to keep both AVON and *Films On Demand*)
- The faculty librarian created an online, self-enrolled flex activity so that faculty could learn about our streaming video collections *Films On Demand* and *Academic Video Online.* Money to pay for the time to create the flex activity were included in the CARES/HEERF funding request for AVON.
- The Library updated its information in the Faculty Handbook, including mentioning it as a space for adjuncts to work and meet with students.
- Student Access Services (SAS) used LRC 8 and 9 for disability testing in June 2021. The Library has offered to have this space considered as a distraction-free testing location for SAS students as well.

e) GOAL: Improve our collections

- The Library is working with Siskiyou County Libraries to formalize our materials sharing process.
- The Library is now purchasing e-textbooks for reserves whenever possible to help increase student access.
- The faculty librarian volunteered to be the new campus OER Liaison. This has prompted increased coordination with the Bookstore, more involvement with faculty, and additional outreach activities for students (such as the Textbook Connection EdTALK). This has also provided the Library an opportunity to raise awareness about ZTC library ebook textbook options.

2. Describe progress on assessing SLOs and PLOs for the program.

Thus far during the pandemic, the Library has not pushed instructors to collect student feedback on library class support. Most faculty and students, including the librarian, seem to be in "survival mode." Without this, the Library does not have much assessment data for 2021. The

Library hopes to be able to collect more assessment data again starting in Spring 2022.
When data is available, the Library uses the most recent Institutional Set Standards as agreed on by the Academic Senate when determining if our SLOs have been met:

- Transfer courses (such as ENGL 1001): ≥67%
- Credit courses (such as ENGL 0900): ≥67%
- Basic Skills courses (such as ENGL 0850): ≥45%
- Vocational courses: ≥70%

Library SLO #1: Students who receive formal research instruction provided by the COS library will be able to effectively locate needed information using a variety of library resources.
Normally, this SLO is evaluated by post-session evaluations but in Fall 2021 this SLO was measured using the responses to a class discussion forum in all three sections of Liz Carlyle's ENGL 1001 classes. The assignment asked students to choose keywords for a topic of their choosing and to find two articles using the library's EBSCO databases. Liz had imported and modified the Library's research modules from the Canvas Commons which covered how to get to and select a database, how to use the basic features of EBSCO, and how to choose basic keywords (advanced searching was not covered at this point in the semester). Of the 46 students who attempted the assignment, all students were able to find two database articles. Of the same 46 students, 39 did a good job at choosing basic keywords for their topic. Three students attempted to choose keywords but either vastly oversimplified their topic (for example, a topic on the impact the COVID-19 pandemic has had on the music industry was searched as simply *music*) or sentence fragments more suitable to natural language searching. Four students did not supply keywords. Since 100% were able to find articles in the database and 84.8% of students did a good job at choosing keywords, the students in this class met this library SLO.

On the Library's Spring 2021 annual student survey, 73% of respondents reported that "The library provides information and instruction for students to help them develop their research skills (Consider things like staff assistance, information handouts, the library web site & classroom instruction)" (rated as Strongly Agree or Agree on survey). While this is down from 89% in 2019, it is still high enough to be another indication that the Library is helping students achieve this SLO.

Library SLO #2: Students who participate in formal research instruction will be able to evaluate for credibility information provided by the library, Internet resources, and other information sources.
This was not assessed through classroom instruction.
On the Library's Spring 2021 annual Student Survey, 69% of respondents reported that "The library staff helped me learn how to find credible information in the library, on the internet, or using other sources (can be in person or Zoom, by phone/text/email, library videos/handouts used in class, or through in-class librarian visits/support)" (rated as Strongly Agree or Agree on survey). While this is down from 79% in 2019, it is still high enough to be an indication that the Library is helping students achieve this SLO.

Library SLO #3: Students who use the COS Library and utilize its resources, services, and formal instruction will appreciate the value of libraries in supporting academic and/or career success and in supporting life-long learning.
On the Library's 2021 annual Student Survey, 77% of respondents reported that "Having used

the COS Library's resources, services, and instruction, I appreciate the value of libraries in supporting student success" (rated as Strongly Agree or Agree on survey). While this is down from 98% in 2019, it is still high enough to be an indication that the Library is helping students achieve this SLO.

The Library feels that the decline in survey numbers are due to the impacts of the pandemic. With the closure of our space and fewer class visits, the Library's opportunities to interact with students has been greatly reduced. We will continue to look for ways to engage with, support, and educate students during the pandemic, such as increased class visits, the self-enrolled research courses, and social media marketing.

1. **Discuss any support or obstacles encountered by the program.**

The Library's primary current challenges are:

- Staff shortages due to 2020 retirements, delays in rehiring positions, and a reliance on adjunct contracts for the faculty librarian
- Engaging and supporting students in our mostly-online environment and encouraging them to take advantage of Library services
- Lack of a plan for LIBR 1001
- Lack of "zoning" in the Library so that our space can accommodate both quiet study and more noisy student use
- Lack of granular data about online students' use of our online collections so that we can make better choices regarding content and outreach
- Lack of student and faculty input regarding the support and services they need from the Library

2. **Describe program budgetary needs or implications. (Attach completed CQIP form.)**

With an expectation to operate with reduced staff and with a potential new staff hire, the Library will continue to experience staffing challenges.

- Increase in training budget for an anticipated new library employee
- Funding for librarian adjunct hours
- Now that library staffing has been reduced to two employees, consider changing the Faculty Librarian position to an 11-month/214-day or 12-month/255 day contract

The last bullet will require working HR and the Faculty Association in order to come up with a firm cost. This suggestion will be included for consideration in the CQIP for adjunct funding (although without a price tag at this time).

If the hiring search for the Library Technician II fails, the Library needs to have a temp or substitute staff member from elsewhere on campus who can work in the Library when the faculty librarian is unavailable due to class visits, meetings, and planned time off. Unexpected, irregular closures diminish the Library's reliability and take a surprising amount of time to appropriately advertise.

The Library is in contact with Facilities regarding whether or not “zoning” would be possible anywhere in our space. This would allow us to better accommodate tours, class visits, and events, especially if the Lounge area could be a separate space. If this idea is possible, it may generate a future CQIP once budget implications are known.

Appendix A: Fall 2021 Library EdTALKS

Name of EdTALK	description	# of times offered
Textbook Connection: Learn About Your Textbook Options	Students will learn about textbook options on campus, such as Library Reserves and ebooks, Basecamp’s textbook programs, OER, and the Bookstore. Students will leave the session with a game plan for making sure they have textbooks for their classes. Co-hosted with someone from Basecamp	6
Using Wikipedia Wisely in College Research	While Wikipedia isn’t always a great source for college research assignments, it can still be a helpful tool during the research process for background information, for database keyword ideas, for fact-checking other sources, and as a source for more appropriate sources.	2
Is this Website Credible?	Students will learn about techniques for evaluating online sources for reliability.	2
Getting Started with Library Research	This workshop is tailored to whatever information the student attendees need! It can cover everything from how to use the Library catalog to finding databases on the Library web site to keyword searching. Ideally, students with research assignments will leave the session with search strategies and possibly even sources they can use (depends on the number of attendees).	2
Finding Articles in Library Databases	This workshop is tailored to whatever information the student attendees need, with a focus on articles, especially scholarly ones! It can cover everything from how to identify a scholarly article to database searching techniques. Ideally, students with research assignments will leave the session with search strategies and possibly even sources they can use (depends on the number of attendees).	2